



HijackThis gives you its statement of purpose

the opening of your browser—and subsequently your computer—to harsher spyware attacks.

So, essentially, what HijackThis does is lists all the installed browser add-ons, start-up settings and buttons that may have been installed on your browser with or without your permission. HijackThis scans special zones of your Registry and hard drives, and lists the contents of these areas—those that are generally accessed by browser hijackers. It is up to you to decide what to delete and what to keep. However, the software does give a description of what the entries mean, and makes recommendations.

The application executable is just 213 KB, and gives you the option of a plaintext log file of the entries found on your Registry and hard drives. Most of these entries can be removed or disabled by the software.

You should, though, be sure of what you're deleting or disabling, as you may inadvertently disable a key function of your computer. And this is where HijackThis lacks. It is not meant for novices. A little knowledge of your system Registry is a must.